Group

Defining and Classifying Groups

- **Group:**
  - Two or more individuals interacting and interdependent, who have come together to achieve particular objectives
- **Formal Group:**
  - Defined by the organization's structure with designated work assignments establishing tasks
- **Informal Group:**
  - Alliances that are neither formally structured nor organizationally determined
  - Appear naturally in response to the need for social contact

Subclassifications of Groups

Formal Groups

- **Task Group**
  - Those working together to complete a job or task in an organization but not limited by hierarchical boundaries
- **Command Group**
  - A group composed of the individuals who report directly to a given manager

Informal Groups

- **Interest Group**
  - Members work together to attain a specific objective with which each is concerned
- **Friendship Group**
  - Those brought together because they share one or more common characteristics

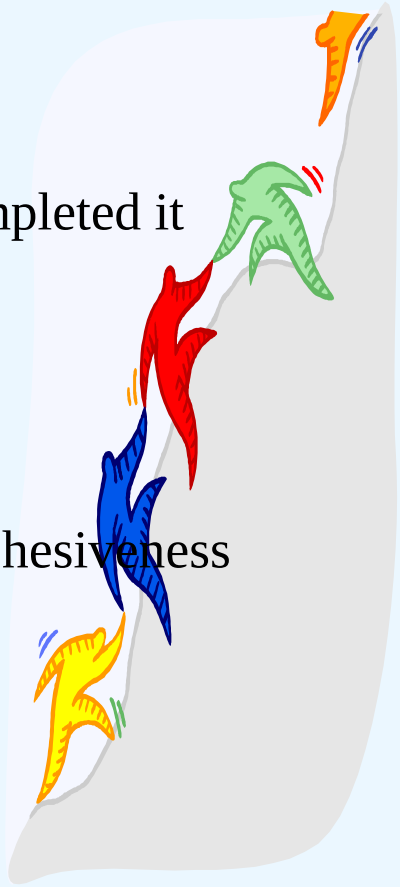
Why do people develop social identity?

- **Security**
- **Similarity**
- **Distinctiveness**
- **Status**
- **Power**

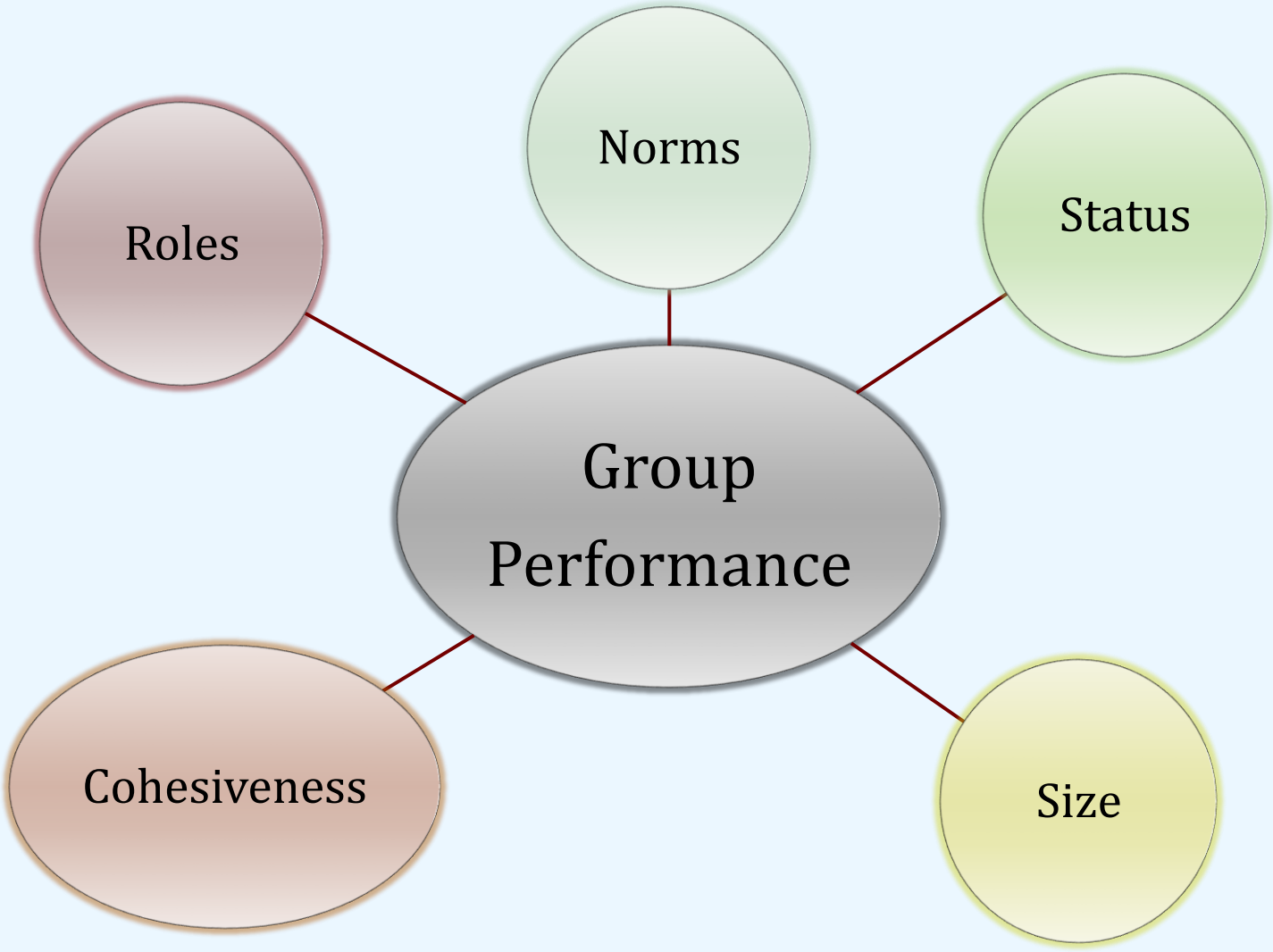


The Five Stages of Group Development- Tuckman,1965

1. **Forming stage**
   - Members feel much uncertainty
   - Inclusion of members
   - Task in hand and the utilization of resources to completed it
2. **Storming stage**
   - Lots of conflict between members of the group
3. **Norming stage**
   - Members have developed close relationships and cohesiveness
   - Establishing norms
4. **Performing stage**
   - The group is finally fully functional
5. **Adjourning Stage**
   - In temporary groups, characterized by concern with wrapping up activities rather than performance



Group Properties



Group Roles

- **A role is defined as a set of recurring behavior that is expected from a member by other s in a group**
- **Role Perception-An individual's view of how he or she is supposed to act in a given situation**
- **Role Expectations-How others believe a person should act in a given situation**
- **Psychological Contract-An unwritten agreement that sets out what management expects from an employee and vice versa.**
- **Role Conflict-A situation in which an individual is confronted by divergent role expectations.**
- **Role Strain-The strain experienced by an individual when incompatible behavior or expectations are associated with a single social role.**

Philip Zimbardo's Experiment

- **Set up a make-believe jail, assigning some student volunteers to the role of guards and other volunteers to the role of prisoners (1972).**
- **Aim was to observe as to how far playing these different parts led to changes in attitudes and behavior.**
- **Students who played at being guards quickly assumed an authoritarian manner; while prisoners showed a mixture of apathy and rebelliousness.**
- **Concluded that behavior in prisons is more influenced by the nature of the prison situation itself than by the individual characteristics of those involved.**

Group Norms

- **Norms**
  - Acceptable standards of behavior within a group that are shared by the group's members
- **Classes of Norms**
  - Performance norms - level of acceptable work
  - Appearance norms - what to wear
  - Social arrangement norms - friendships and the like
  - Allocation of resources norms - distribution and assignments of jobs and material



Group Size

- **Group size affects behavior**
- **Size**
- **Best use of a group:**

Attribute	Small	Large
Speed	X	
Individual Performance	X	
Problem Solving		X
Diverse Input		X
Fact-finding Goals		X
Overall Performance	X	

Status

- A socially defined position or rank given to groups or group members by others.
- Status can act as a significant motivator
- Sources of Status:
  - ✓ The power a person wields over others
  - ✓ A person's ability to contribute to a group's goals
  - ✓ An individual's personal characteristics

MILGRAM EXPERIMENT

Stanley Milgram was a psychologist at Yale University

He was interested to study as to how our actions are shaped by obedience to authority

The research subjects (participants) were assigned the role of teachers and his research assistants were assigned the role of learners

Note: The participants drew slips of paper to determine their role but all the slips read teacher

The teachers (research subjects) were given a list of word pairs that they would teach the learners (assistants to Milgram)

The teacher began by reading the word pairs to the learners and then he would read the first word of teach pair and give his learners four possible answers

The teacher and the learner were separated by a wall and the learner would press a button to indicate his response

MILGRAM EXPERIMENT

If the response was incorrect the teacher would administer an electric shock to the learner and the shock would increase by 15 volts with each wrong answer

In reality no shock was administered

After every shock, the learner would bang on the wall, complain of chest pain and beg to be released

After several pleas, the learner would cease to respond

Many of the teachers were extremely stressed and desired to stop the experiment

However, when assured that the researcher would be responsible for the outcome, the participants continued the experiment

In Milgram's sample, 65% (26 out of 40) administered the experiment's final massive shock

Group Cohesiveness

The degree to which group members are attracted to each other and are motivated to stay in the group.

- **How to encourage Group Cohesiveness?**

- **Consequences of Group Cohesiveness**
  - Group Cohesiveness and Productivity

Common Threats to Group Effectiveness

- **Groupthink**
  - A phenomenon in which the norm for consensus overrides the realistic appraisal of alternative courses of action
  - Hinders performance

- Symptoms:
  - Members apply direct pressures on those who express doubts about shared views or who question the alternative favored by the majority
  - Members who have doubts or differing points of view keep silent about misgivings
  - There appears to be an illusion of unanimity

Common Threats to Group Effectiveness

- Minimize Groupthink by:
  - Reduce the size of the group to 10 or less
  - Encourage group leaders to be impartial
  - Appoint a "devil's advocate"
  - Use exercises on diversity

- **Groupshift**
  - A change in decision risk between a group's decision and an individual decision that a member within the group would make; the shift can be toward either conservatism or greater risk

Group Decision Making Techniques

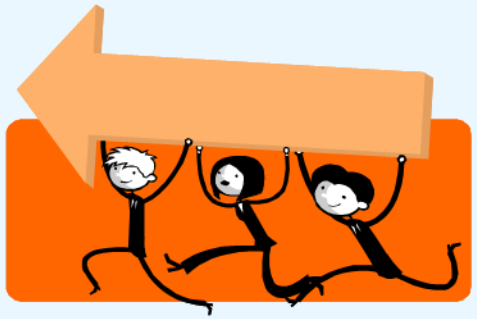
- **Interacting Groups**-Typical groups in which members interact with each other face to face.

- ✓ **Brainstorming**-An idea-generation process that specifically encourages any and all alternatives while withholding any criticism of those alternatives.
- ✓ **Nominal Group Technique**-A group decision-making method in which individual members meet face to face to pool their judgments in a systematic but independent fashion.
- ✓ **Electronic Meeting**-A meeting in which members interact on computers, allowing for anonymity of comments and aggregation of votes.

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Differences between Groups and Teams

- Work Group
  - A group that interacts primarily to share information and to make decisions to help each group member perform within his or her area of responsibility
  - No joint effort required



- Work Team
  - Generates positive synergy through coordinated effort. The individual efforts result in a performance that is greater than the sum of the individual inputs

Comparing Work Groups and Work Teams

